

A

Agreeing

Maria doesn't approve of letting children eat sweets and chocolate, and her husband is **of the same mind / of like mind**. [has the same opinion]

The four people are all agreeing in an informal way with the woman in the centre.



¹ something that you say when you decide to do something bad because other people are getting an advantage from doing it and you cannot stop them (informal) ² support the official view of an organisation ³ saying the same things in public

B

Disagreeing

Manager: The only choice is to introduce my plan for longer working hours. It'll increase our productivity levels, which will be good for us all.

Adam: **I beg to differ**¹. I think the staff will get very tired, and that will reduce productivity.

Manager: There's **a world of difference**² between expecting people to work twelve hours a day and asking them to occasionally work ten hours, which is all I'm asking.

Adam: Ten hours and fifteen minutes actually.

Manager: Now you're just **splitting hairs**³.

Adam: Well, you're **at odds with**⁴ your staff on this one. Everyone thinks you're **barking up the wrong tree**⁵! They say that paying people more would be a far better way to increase productivity.

Manager: Hey, I'm not exactly **a lone voice**⁶! Joanna, you backed my plan yesterday.

Joanna: Yes, well, now **I'm torn**⁷. I'm **in two minds**⁸ as to whether it'd work or not.

Manager: Well, I'm sorry this **note of discord**⁹ has crept into our discussions. I know it's a difficult decision to make. Tom, what do you think? You're usually good at **pouring oil on troubled waters**¹⁰.

¹ I disagree (formal) ² a big difference ³ arguing about whether unimportant details are exactly correct

⁴ have a different opinion from ⁵ trying to achieve something in the wrong way or being wrong about the reason for something (informal) ⁶ the only person with a specific opinion ⁷ I'm undecided ⁸ unable to decide ⁹ disagreement (formal) ¹⁰ calming down a difficult situation

45.1 Correct the mistakes in these idioms from A opposite.

- 1 A: I think we should go home now.
B: You took the sentence right out of my mouth.
- 2 A: This project is a total disaster, isn't it?
B: Yes, that's about the shape of it!
- 3 A: I think Jack is arrogant and rude.
B: Talk about it!
- 4 A: I think they were wrong to sack George just for being late a few times.
B: I think most of us are of the same meaning about that.
- 5 A: I'd never have expected to see you at a casino. I thought you didn't approve of gambling.
B: Well, in the end I thought, 'If you can't win 'em, join 'em.'

45.2 Complete each idiom.

- 1 They were having a terrible row, so I tried to pour oil on troubled
- 2 Ryan's convinced he's right, but I think he's barking up the wrong
- 3 The CEO wants to ensure we're all singing from the same
- 4 It's part of a lawyer's job to be pedantic, to spend time splitting
- 5 Absolutely. You took the words right out of my
- 6 Our normally friendly meetings have been spoilt by a note of recently.
- 7 You may think it's a good idea, but I beg to
- 8 I don't know what to think. I'm in two

45.3 Choose the correct word to complete each idiom.

- 1 He certainly is a nasty person. You're not [untrue / wrong / false]!
- 2 When everyone else was ignoring the situation, Kate was a(n) [lone / only / alone] voice pointing out the danger we were in.
- 3 It's so hard to decide – I'm really [worn / torn / broken] about what to do.
- 4 As twins, Una and I tend to be of [alike / similar / like] mind over most issues.
- 5 That politician is at [difference / minds / odds] with his party over their economic policy.
- 6 The company's spokespeople were briefed before talking to the press to ensure they were all on [note / tone / message].

45.4 Replace the underlined part of each sentence with an idiom.

- 1 There's a big difference between being poor and not having as much money as you'd like.
- 2 I have a different opinion from everyone else in my family about where we should go on holiday.
- 3 Please do all you can to calm things down. I hate it when people argue.
- 4 The politician was sacked for not following the party line.

45.5 Do you agree or disagree with these statements? Respond to each statement with an idiom.

- 1 Men are better drivers than women.
- 2 Learning grammar rules is a waste of time.
- 3 Footballers deserve to be paid a lot more money than politicians.
- 4 TV has a bad effect on family life.
- 5 I couldn't live without my mobile phone.